ARTIST

LOUIE HUMBLE

Session rates, royalties & a faster way to finish songs

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THE DEAL AT A GLANCE

$200
per 4-hour session
Normally $300, so he saves $100 every session.

15%
of the master
Your share of the recording's income, in writing.

$140
you keep, in cash
What's left of the $200 after $60 studio rent.

2
sessions per song
A 3rd session on the same song is full price ($300).

The idea

Louie is talented, but he doesn't like to write, so his songs take a lot of sessions. He likes to punch in. You like working with him, so he gets a lower rate than your listed prices.

The cash he pays up front always covers your studio rent and pays you for your time. The 15% master share is your upside if his songs take off. The two-session rule makes sure his slow pace costs him, not you.

Your cost: studio rent

$15 per hour

2 hrs **$30** | 4 hrs **$60** | 8 hrs **$120**

Your listed prices

What everyone else pays

2 hrs **$200** | 4 hrs **$300** | 8 hrs **$500**

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01 PRICING

Rent is $15 an hour, so a 4-hour session costs you $60 no matter what he pays.

What you keep on a 4-hour session

LOUIE PAYS	RENT	YOU KEEP	PER HOUR	ASK FOR
$300 (normal)	$60	**$240**	$60	None
$250	$60	**$190**	$47.50	About 10%
$200 RECOMMENDED	$60	**$140**	**$35**	**About 15%**
$150 LOWEST	$60	**$90**	$22.50	20–25%
$100 × TOO LOW	$60	**$40**	$10	Don't go here

i **Rule of thumb:** the bigger the discount, the bigger the royalty. Don't go under $150 for 4 hours. Below that you're working for almost nothing.

Louie's rate for every session length

SESSION	LISTED PRICE	LOUIE'S PRICE	HE SAVES	RENT	YOU KEEP
2 hours	$200	**$100**	$100	$30	**$70**
4 hours	$300	**$200**	$100	$60	**$140**
8 hours	$500	**$350**	$150	$120	**$230**

$ **Want to be more generous?** Charge $150 for 4 hours plus 20–25% of the master. You still keep $90 per session.

! **Cash covers rent first.** The royalty is extra on top. Never count on it to pay for the room.

Other ways to set it up

Per-song package	A flat price per song for a set number of hours. Extra hours at your normal rate.
Prepaid block of hours	He prepays a monthly block (say 10 hours) at a discount. Covers rent up front.
Deferred fee	Part now. The rest comes out of his royalties first, then your share continues.
Composition share	Only if the beat is yours. The beat usually earns about 50% of the composition.

02 SESSION RULES

These make sure his slow pace costs him, not you.

1 Two sessions per song

If a song needs a third 4-hour session, that session is full price ($300). It gives him a reason to come in ready.

2 Deposit when he books

At least $60, so the rent is covered. It counts toward the session and isn't refunded if he cancels or doesn't show.

3 Keep his rate private

Leave it off your website. Your listed prices stay the same for everyone else.

4 Get it in writing

His verbal OK on royalties isn't enough. Sign a one-page agreement before the next session (see the checklist).

03 FASTER SESSIONS

His words, your engineering. Less time figuring out what to say, more time recording.

1 Concept before the session

Pick the beat, a title or topic, and a reference track before he walks in. Most wasted time is deciding what the song is about.

2 Voice memos at home

Send the beat a few days early. He freestyles into his phone and sends you the memos, so he shows up already knowing his flow and hook.

3 Hook first, always

Don't start verses until the hook is locked. The hook sets the topic, and the verses go faster after it.

4 Freestyle, comp, punch

Loop the beat and let him freestyle 4–6 passes. Keep every take, comp his best lines, then punch in to fill the gaps. A transcription tool can turn the takes into a lyric sheet.

5 One song at a time

No new song until the current one has a full rough. Bounce a rough mix before every session ends.

6 If he wants writing help

He can bring his own writer and pay or split with them out of his share. It doesn't change your deal.

→ **A typical session:** concept and memos are done before he arrives → hook (first hour) → freestyle passes and comp for verse 1 → punch-ins → verse 2 → bounce a rough before he leaves.

04 THE ROYALTY MATH

Streaming pays roughly $0.003–$0.005 per stream.

THE HONEST NUMBER

AT 15% OF THE MASTER, EACH $100 DISCOUNT TAKES ABOUT 130,000–220,000 STREAMS TO EARN BACK.

$45–$75

Your 15% of 100,000 streams (about $300–$500 total).

~$400

Cash you give up per month if he books a 4-hour session every week.

$140

Your real pay per session. The royalty is a bonus if a song takes off.

05 PAPERWORK CHECKLIST

Do these before the next session.

- [ ] **One-page agreement.** His rate, the deposit, the two-session rule, your 15% master share, which songs it covers, and what happens if he signs to a label (your share stays).
- [ ] **Distributor splits.** He adds you on his distributor's splits feature (DistroKid, TuneCore and others have one) so your 15% is paid to you directly.
- [ ] **If the beat is yours.** Sign a split sheet for every song and register with BMI or ASCAP and The MLC.
- [ ] **SoundExchange.** A Letter of Direction from Louie can pay you a producer share of his SoundExchange royalties.
- [ ] **Lawyer for anything bigger.** Have an entertainment lawyer review bigger deals, like co-owning his masters.

THE BOTTOM LINE

$200 / 4 HOURS

Covers $60 rent and pays you $140.

15% OF THE MASTER

Signed, and paid through his distributor.

2 SESSIONS PER SONG

Plus a deposit when he books.

This is a business plan, not legal advice. Streaming rates vary by platform and country, so the royalty figures are rough estimates.